

For an investor in training, alternative investments are something we shouldn't be giving too much attention to at the start, especially as the barrier to entry is high. Most of us don't start out with \$10 000 to put towards a luxury bag or a Picasso piece.

In the world of investing, there are many types of investments that investors in training have access to — from index funds to ETFs, REITs to commodities. Once broken down in easy-to-understand language, the structure of these investments is digestible even for the most novice investor.

Actionable steps

1. See if you can recall the difference between an index fund and an ETF.
2. Note down two investment types that interest you from what we've covered.
3. Note down the definition of the three most common indexes:
 - the S&P 500
 - the Dow
 - NASDAQ.